

Project Design Phase

Module 1: Problem Solution Fit

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Team ID :	SWTID-2026-4107
Project Name :	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

1. Problem Statement

In organizations, employees frequently require standard laptops for onboarding, replacement, or business needs. When laptop requests are handled manually through emails, forms, and separate approval processes, it creates several operational challenges:

- **High Operational Overhead:** IT teams spend considerable time reviewing requests, checking details, obtaining approvals, and coordinating laptop orders.
- **Delayed Procurement:** Manual approval and procurement processes can slow down the delivery of laptops to employees.
- **Inconsistent Request Handling:** Different employees or departments may provide incomplete or inconsistent laptop request information.
- **Manual Approval Tracking:** IT teams need to manually track whether a request has been approved, rejected, or is still pending.
- **Lack of Process Automation:** Repetitive tasks such as approval routing, task creation, and status updates require unnecessary manual intervention.
- **Limited Visibility:** Employees and IT teams may not have a clear view of the current status of a laptop request.

2. Target Audience & Stakeholders

- **Employees:** Submit standard laptop requests for onboarding, replacement, or business requirements.
- **IT Service Desk:** Reviews requests and manages laptop provisioning activities.
- **IT Procurement Team:** Handles laptop purchasing and vendor coordination.
- **Approvers/Managers:** Review and approve laptop requests based on employee and business requirements.
- **System Administrators:** Configure and maintain the automated Flow Designer workflow.

3. Problem-Solution Fit Matrix

Identified Pain Points	Proposed System Capability	Business Value & Outcome
Time-consuming manual processing	Automated Laptop Request Flow	Automates repetitive procurement activities and saves IT team time.
Delayed approvals	Automated Approval Routing	Sends laptop requests to the appropriate manager for approval.
Incomplete or inconsistent requests	Standard Laptop Request Form	Collects required employee and laptop information in a consistent format.
Manual task creation	Automatic Task Generation	Creates procurement/fulfillment tasks automatically after approval.
Poor request visibility	Automated Status Updates	Keeps employees and IT teams informed about request progress.
Manual procurement coordination	Flow Designer Automation	Connects request, approval, procurement, and fulfillment activities into one workflow.

4. Summary of Fit

The Streamlining IT Procurement solution directly addresses the delays and manual effort involved in standard laptop ordering. By using ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate request submission, approval, task creation, and status updates, the solution provides a structured and efficient laptop procurement process with minimal manual intervention.